

Safeguarding Vulnerable Adults Policy

HSE NATIONAL POLICY COMPLIANT

1 PURPOSE

To ensure all residents are protected from abuse, neglect, and exploitation, based on the HSE National Policy "Safeguarding Vulnerable Persons at Risk of Abuse" (2014), HIQA standards, and the Health Act 2007.

2 SCOPE & DEFINITIONS

Applies to all staff, contractors, volunteers, and management. Abuse may be physical, emotional, sexual, financial, institutional, or neglect. Any suspicion, disclosure, or evidence must be acted on immediately.

3 RESPONSIBILITIES

- ✓ All staff are mandatory reporters
- ✓ The Person in Charge (PIC) is the Designated Safeguarding Officer
- ✓ The Governance Officer oversees all safeguarding reviews and audits

4 REPORTING PROCEDURES

- ⚠ **Step 1:** If abuse suspected or disclosed, report to PIC immediately
- ⚠ **Step 2:** PIC logs concern in Safeguarding Log and notifies HSE Safeguarding & Protection Team
- ⚠ **Step 3:** Immediate safety plans implemented for the resident
- ⚠ **Step 4:** Investigation per HSE Safeguarding procedures and HIQA guidance

5 TRAINING & SUPPORT

- ✓ Mandatory safeguarding training at induction and annually; attendance records maintained
- ✓ Residents informed of rights and how to report concerns; advocacy services available on request
- ✓ All reports handled confidentially except where disclosure required for protection

6 EXTERNAL REPORTING & MONITORING

- ✓ **HSE Safeguarding & Protection Team** — direct reporting available
- ✓ **HIQA** — (021) 240 9300 / concerns@hiqa.ie
- ✓ Governance Officer reviews all safeguarding logs monthly; trends analysed and reported to the Board